

Nerva OS — Your AI Business Assistant

Your operating system for running a business with AI

Welcome to Nerva OS. This is the kit that turns Claude into a full-time business assistant — one that knows who you are, what you sell, how you write, and which tools you use. It runs on your own machine, remembers everything between sessions, and ships with 37 specialised skills covering marketing, research, sales, automation, and operations.

By the end of this guide you will have a working assistant you can talk to like a colleague. Total setup time: about 15 minutes.

What You're Setting Up

Piece	What it does
Your AI Assistant	A Claude-powered business operator that lives in a folder on your computer and remembers everything between sessions
Browser Control	Optional add-on so the assistant can open websites, fill forms, take screenshots, and run real tasks for you
37 Skills	Pre-built playbooks for copywriting, research, ads, content, automation and more (Engineering Pack with 56 more skills available separately)
Memory System	A persistent file that stores your name, business, voice, tools and preferences so you never repeat yourself

Step 1 — Create a Claude Account

1. Go to claude.ai
2. Click **Sign up** (top right) and use your business email
3. Verify your email
4. Once signed in, click your profile (top left) then **Settings** then **Plans**
5. Upgrade to **Claude Max (\$100/month)**

The Max plan is required. The free plan runs out of capacity inside an hour of real work. Max gives you ~5x the usage and is the only plan that supports the long sessions Nerva OS needs.

Step 2 — Install Claude Desktop App

This is the app you will use every day. It runs Claude on your computer rather than in a browser tab.

Mac

1. Go to **claude.ai/download**
2. Click the button that says exactly: **Download for Mac**
3. Open the downloaded file
4. Drag the **Claude** icon into the **Applications** folder
5. Open **Applications**, double-click **Claude**

Windows

1. Go to **claude.ai/download**
 2. Click the button that says exactly: **Download for Windows**
 3. Open the downloaded `.exe` file
 4. Click **Yes** to the security prompt
 5. Click through the installer (Next, Next, Install)
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Step 3 — Sign In and Open Claude Code

1. Open the **Claude** desktop app
2. Sign in with the same email you used for claude.ai
3. In the top menu, look for **Claude Code** — click it to enable
4. A code panel will open inside the app. This is where the magic happens.

Claude Code is the part that can read files, write files, and run real tasks on your computer. The chat panel is the conversation. They work together.

Windows Users Only — Install Git

Windows does not come with Git, which Nerva OS needs to download itself.

1. Go to git-scm.com/download/win
2. Download and run the installer
3. Click **Next** through every screen (the defaults are correct)
4. **Important:** on the screen titled "Adjusting your PATH environment", make sure **Git from the command line and also from 3rd-party software** is selected
5. Finish the installer
6. **Close Claude Desktop completely and reopen it** — this is required for Git to be recognised

Step 4 — Paste the Setup Prompt

This is the moment where Nerva OS gets installed on your machine.

1. Open **Claude Desktop**
2. Click into the **Claude Code** panel
3. Copy the entire block below
4. Paste it into Claude Code and press Enter

```
You are about to install Nerva OS – my AI business assistant kit.
```

```
Please do the following in order:
```

1. Clone the Nerva OS repository to ~/nerva-os
(`git clone https://github.com/nerva-os/nerva-os.git ~/nerva-os`)
2. Copy the workspace template from ~/nerva-os/workspace
to ~/my-assistant (this is where I will work every day)
3. Copy every skill from ~/nerva-os/skills/ to ~/.claude/skills/
(there are 37 skills – confirm the count when done)
4. Open ~/my-assistant/CLAUDE.md and follow the
first-run-setup skill to onboard me
5. Once setup is complete, ask me the 7 onboarding
questions to build my memory file

```
When everything is ready, tell me to close Claude Desktop,  
reopen it, and open the ~/my-assistant folder.
```

Step 5 — Open Your Workspace

Once setup is done and you have reopened Claude Desktop:

- 1. In Claude Desktop, click **File** then **Open Folder**
 - 2. Choose the folder called **my-assistant** in your home directory
 - 3. The assistant will load with all 37 skills available
 - 4. You will see a greeting using your name
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Step 6 — The Assistant Asks 7 Questions

The first time you open the my-assistant folder, your assistant will run a short onboarding interview. This builds the memory file so it never has to ask twice.

The 7 questions:

- 1. What is your name and what should I call you?
- 2. What is the name of your business and what does it do?
- 3. Who are your customers (one or two sentences)?
- 4. What is your role — owner, marketer, operator, something else?
- 5. What is the single biggest thing slowing your business down right now?
- 6. How do you prefer to communicate — short and punchy, warm and friendly, or detailed and thorough?
- 7. Which tools do you already use (Gmail, a CRM, a calendar, ad accounts, anything else)?

Answer in your own words. The assistant saves your answers to `./memory/USER.md` and uses them in every future conversation.

What You Can Do Now

Once onboarding is complete, try any of these prompts to see your assistant in action:

Prompt	What happens
"Research my top 3 competitors and tell me what they're doing well"	Runs deep research, returns a structured report with sources

Prompt	What happens
"Write me a sales email to a cold prospect in my industry"	Drafts in your voice using the sales-automator and copywriting skills
"Create a week of social content for my business"	Generates posts across platforms with the social-content skill
"Analyse the market for [your niche] right now"	Pulls live signal from Reddit, X and the web over the last 30 days
"Plan my week — here is what's on"	Breaks it down into priorities and a daily schedule
"Write a blog post about [topic]"	Long-form post, SEO-aware, in your brand voice
"Check my email and tell me what's urgent"	(requires Gmail connection) reads inbox, summarises, suggests replies

You can also talk to it like a colleague: *"give me three angles for a Facebook ad about our service"*, *"draft a follow-up email to the lead from yesterday"*, *"what's a fair price for this product"*. There is no wrong way to ask.

Your 37 Skills — Quick Reference

Skills are pre-built playbooks. You don't need to memorise them — your assistant picks the right one automatically. Here is what's in the kit.

Marketing & Content (10)

copywriting, humanizer, avoid-AI-writing patterns, content-creator, social-content, social-orchestrator, ad-creative, email-sequence, email-composer, direct-response-copy

Research & Intelligence (6)

deep-research, research-analyst, reddit-insights, last30days (trends), competitive-cartographer, competitor-alternatives

Sales & Strategy (5)

sales-automator, paid-ads, indie-monetization-strategist, product-appeal-analyzer, tech-entrepreneur-coach-adhd

AI & Automation (5)

playwright (browser automation), webapp-testing, qa, prompt-engineer, agent-creator

Foundation (5)

first-run-setup, skill-creator, writing-plans, brainstorming, orchestrator

Productivity & Quality (4)

verification-before-completion, diagramming-expert, technical-writer, youtube-summarizer

Personal (2)

personal-finance-coach, retro

Want more? An Engineering Pack with 56 additional skills (backend, frontend, devops, data, security) is available separately.

Connect More Tools (Optional)

These three extras unlock the next level of usefulness. All require Node.js. If you don't have Node.js yet, your assistant will walk you through it.

Browser Control (Playwright)

Lets the assistant open websites, fill forms, take screenshots, and run real tasks. Ask your assistant to set up Playwright and it will handle the rest.

Gmail

Read, summarise and draft replies to your email. Ask your assistant to connect Gmail. A Google sign-in screen will open — click your email then click Allow.

Google Calendar

See your schedule, find free times, draft meeting prep. Same flow as Gmail.

Telegram Notifications

Get pinged on your phone when long tasks finish, or chat with your assistant from anywhere. Your assistant will walk you through creating a bot in Telegram.

Useful Links

Link	What it is
claude.ai	Sign in, manage your plan
claude.ai/download	Download Claude Desktop
Nerva OS (GitHub)	https://github.com/nerva-os/nerva-os.git — source for the kit and skills
Nerva OS	nerva-os.com — homepage and docs
Email Support	support@nerva-os.com — get help from a human

If Something Breaks

Stay calm. Almost every issue is fixed by closing and reopening Claude Desktop.

Symptom	Fix
Skills not showing up	Close Claude Desktop completely, reopen it
Claude keeps asking to set up	Close Claude Desktop, then reopen with the <code>my-assistant</code> folder selected
Claude login loop	Ask your assistant to run <code>claude logout</code> then <code>claude login</code>
Mac developer tools popup	Click Install (not Get Xcode), wait 3 to 5 minutes
Windows says "git not recognised"	Reinstall Git using the PATH fix from the Windows section above
Something else	Email <code><SUPPORT_EMAIL></code> and we will sort it

Built by Nerva OS